

TD Bank Group joins the Open Invention Network community

Open Invention Network (OIN) has announced that TD Bank Group (TD) has joined as a community member. The group offers a complete range of financial products and services to more than 26 million customers globally.

Keith Bergelt, CEO of Open Invention Network, said, “The financial services and fintech industries are increasingly relying on open source technologies for building and integrating feature-rich platforms. As the first major North American bank to join our community, we are pleased that an established leader like TD is committed to patent non-aggression in core Linux and adjacent open source technologies.”

OIN’s community practices patent non-aggression in core Linux and adjacent OSS technologies by cross-licensing Linux system patents to one another on a royalty-free basis. Patents owned by OIN are similarly licensed royalty-free to any organisation that agrees not to assert its patents against the Linux system.



Josh Death, intellectual property and patentable innovations lead at TD, said, “We remain focused on leveraging the best technologies for our platforms and are excited to join the Open Invention Network (OIN), that supports protection from patent infringement claims for the greater good of the wider innovation community.”

Microsoft joins Rust Foundation

As per a blog post by Microsoft, it is joining industry partners as one of the



founding members of the Rust Foundation. The foundation is a new independent organisation established to steward the Rust programming language and ecosystem, and support Rust’s maintainers.

The post by Nell Shamrell-Harrington, principal software engineer, Microsoft, and board director at the

Rust Foundation, said, “As Rust’s popularity has grown, it has continued to demonstrate outstanding language stewardship and a strong track record of keeping Rust true to its goals of performance, reliability, and productivity. It has been a joy for me to contribute to this success as the lead editor of *This Week in Rust*, and as a member of several Rust working groups and teams.”

The post adds that any open source project—especially a language ecosystem—is only as strong as its community of users and contributors. The creation of the Rust Foundation ensures that Rust will remain driven by and for the global Rustacean community.

As per the blog post, open source software and languages are of critical importance both to Microsoft and to the entire tech industry. This is especially true for systems programming languages like Rust.

Shamrell-Harrington added, “As Rust usage in Microsoft grows, we know it is not enough to only use it as open source software. We must also contribute back to it. Joining the Rust Foundation is a way for us to financially support the project, contribute back to the project, and engage more deeply with the Rust community.”

Styra announces strategic hires to senior leadership team

Styra, Inc., the founders of Open Policy Agent (OPA) and leaders in cloud-native authorisation, have announced two strategic hires to its senior leadership team. Steve Erickson and Paul Murphy will serve as vice presidents of engineering and sales, respectively, to support the company’s innovation and growth. The company also shared its 2020 results, including over 300 per cent growth year-over-year, 90 per cent headcount growth and record-breaking open source success with OPA.

The new hires bring proven policy and open source experience to help Styra expand its rapidly growing customer base, support the OPA community, and provide more teams access to the Styra Declarative Authorization Service (DAS), giving them guardrails for Kubernetes and microservices.

Steve Erickson will be bringing deep policy security expertise to the engineering team as VP. In his time as an engineering leader at Illumio, Erickson was responsible for end-to-end policy management, distribution and enforcement capabilities within the Illumio Core and Illumio Edge products.

Paul Murphy comes to Styra with a strong cloud-native background. In his role with FOSSA, Murphy was the head of global sales. Before that, he ran sales for Sysdig.

Murphy added, “Styra is a rocket ship, and I’m thrilled to be on board and part of the team that built both OPA and Styra DAS. I am passionate about the speed, automation and portability that cloud-native can provide, and I’ve helped countless companies make their digital transformations and embrace the cloud. Here at Styra, I’ll be helping our customers get more from OPA, so they can move to the cloud while also minimising risk, mitigating errors and ensuring that deployments are both secure and compliant.”



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